- The Correspondent and the Principal are attending a meeting.

When 'and' connects two or more titles or designations of the same person, the verb is always singular. In sentence 1, two posts are held by the same person. So the verb is singular. In sentence 2, the posts are held by two different persons. Hence the verb is plural.

Observe the following sentences.

- Five rupees has no value these days.
- Three miles is a short distance.
- Two weeks is a long holiday.

Some nouns denoting money, time and distance take a singular verb, as the specific quantity or amount is considered a whole.

Now read these sentences.

- Either Ramesh or Naren is in the wrong.
- Neither Kamal nor Rahim was present at the conference.

Two or more singular subjects connected by or, nor, either…. or, neither… nor, take a singular verb.

Observe the following sentences.

- Either Rahim or his brothers have to be invited.
- Neither his friends nor Victor is aware of the news.

When two subjects, one singular and the other plural, are connected by 'neither….nor', 'either….or', the verb agrees in person with the subject nearer to it.

Read the sentences given below.

- Kumar, as well as his friends, has won the prize.
- The captain, with all his sailors, was drowned.
- The students along with their teacher, have gone on a visit to the Museum.

When two subjects, one singular and the other plural, are connected by 'as well as', 'with', 'along with', 'together with', the verb agrees with the first subject. If the first subject is singular the verb is singular; if the first subject is plural, the verb is plural.

Task 1

I Choose the correct option and complete the sentences.

1. Manoj _____(was, were) present along with his parents.
2. Each of these boys _____ (has, have) passed.
3. Neither Lekha nor Leela _____ (has, have) been selected.
4. Every man, woman and child _____ (was, were) happy.
5. One of the machines _____ (is, are) defective.
6. A number of books _____ (is, are) missing.
7. Seker or his brothers _____ (has, have) done it.
8. To make a promise and then not to keep it _____ (is, are) dishonesty.

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